

PURPOSE: To purchase and implement another piece of playground equipment for student use near the swing set and volleyball court behind the residence halls.

INTRODUCED BY: Annadele Beckman

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE SENATE:

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

Given that there is evidence that time spent outside significantly benefits students' mental health, MSMS students deserve more spaces outdoors that aren't academic or residential. The classes the student body takes are stressful and the students deserve an additional outlet to blow off steam. The students also deserve to regain and retain some of their childhood as they prepare for college and their future.

MSMS has a notoriously abysmal retention rate with many students dropping out due to stress, mental health, or lack of community. As such, implementing playground equipment will help increase student retention as another playground apparatus is a great way for students to engage with each other and feel belonging. Additionally, another piece of equipment can help attract aspiring students as it would add to the uniqueness of MSMS and perhaps become a selling point in student tours.

As MSMS students often rush to get wellness done in time, implementing more options to gain wellness outside will theoretically alleviate some stress regarding wellness. As the swings can only occupy four students, having another apparatus will increase the options for the students to obtain wellness.

Finally, the vast majority of the possible playground equipment listed below relies on simple mechanics. By implementing another piece of equipment, the students will be able to visualize and apply what they learn in their physics classes. For instance, a seesaw is a case study in potential and kinetic energy, gravity, etc. and a merry-go-round is a great example of torque that students can utilize.

SECTION TWO (OPTIONS AND DEFINITIONS):

Upon this resolution's passing, the following options will be sent to the student body to vote on via ranked-choice voting.

Tetherball: A ball is suspended on a cord attached to an upright post that opposing students hit with the aim to tie the cord around the pole.

Seesaw: Also called a teeter-totter, a long plank is balanced in the middle and at the ends people can sit where they alternate pushing off the ground with their feet. Can either be fixed to the ground or able to be picked up and moved.

Merry-go-round: Also called a playground spinner or a roundabout, a merry-go-round is an apparatus that revolves around that people can push and ride on.

Slide: People climb up a ladder or something similar and slide down a smooth surface. Can be either plastic or metal.

SECTION THREE (COSTS):

Below are the costs of each piece of equipment. It is important to note that most playground equipment is intended for children so prices may be different in reality. This section is only intended to be a rough estimate of costs.

Tetherball: Tetherball doesn't require many materials and is much more affordable than the playground equipment below. It'll only require the purchase of a bag of concrete, a metal post (ranges from \$100 to \$500), rope, and a ball. Another material that can be found is an old tire to hold the concrete rather than pouring it into the ground. This project can realistically be done by the students themselves with adult supervision and can be a great way for them to get together as a class and community.

Merry-go-round: There is a big range between \$5000 and \$10,000.

Seesaw: Most seesaws are intended for small children so finding adult seesaws to purchase was difficult. However, there is a "Fly" seesaw by MIO that costs \$4500 and appears to be moveable and also rotates. However, it doesn't have handlebars if that might be a concern, and it's made out of wood which might not weather easily.

An alternative could be to try to create our own. However, it might not be as durable.

Slide: Fortunately, slides don't appear to have an age limit so finding a slide that will fit the students' needs will be relatively easy. They generally range from \$3000 to \$5000.

There are two main options as to who is going to pay for the playground equipment.

Administration can include the costs in the summer renovation costs or it could be a class gift. Students and/or PLUS can help offset costs for the administration by fundraising. There won't be a need to raise money for tetherball.

SECTION FOUR (APPENDIX):

Response 1 (Mrs. Nisa):

“I’m happy about it as long as you guys don’t break your head.”

Response 2 (Anonymous):

“I fully support it. I think the swings get boring after a while and having another outlet would be great.”